TechDella

PDF-03 · TEMPLATE

The creative brief your ads *deserve.*

One brief for Meta, TikTok, LinkedIn and Google: who you are talking to, what you say, how you test it, and the formats each platform needs.

FOR	TIME	OUTPUT
B2B marketers briefing a designer, editor or agency	45 minutes per campaign	A brief, a test plan and a spec sheet in one document

START HERE

How to use this template

A good brief makes the creative team's first draft close to right. It names one audience, one problem, one promise and the proof behind it, then sets how you will judge the result.

01 **Fill in the one-page brief** (page 3) before anyone opens a design tool.

02 **Write the message** (page 4): the problem, the promise, the proof and the objection, in your buyer's words.

03 **Pick hooks to test** (page 5). Creative is now the main lever in most ad platforms, because targeting is increasingly automated.

04 **Set the test plan and naming** (page 6), so results are readable later.

05 **Check the specs** for each platform (pages 7 and 8) and run the pre-launch checklist (page 9).

LABELLING EXAMPLE CREATIVE

If you show ads made for illustration, such as samples in a pitch, label them "Example". Only show a client's real ads with their permission.

Campaign basics

Campaign name	
Platforms	☐ Meta ☐ TikTok ☐ LinkedIn ☐ Google Search ☐ Google Display / Demand Gen / YouTube
Objective (one)	☐ Qualified leads ☐ Demo / call bookings ☐ Trials ☐ Retargeting audience ☐ Awareness
Budget and dates	
Landing page URL	
Brief owner / approver	

STEP 1

The one-page brief

Keep each answer to one or two sentences. If you cannot, the campaign is trying to do too much.

Who exactly is this for? Role, company type, size, market	
What are they trying to get done? The job, in their words	
What is getting in their way? The problem this ad names	
What do we offer? The specific offer in this ad: a call, an audit, a guide, a trial	
Why believe us? Named proof only: case study, number with timeframe, verbatim quote with permission	
What will they doubt? The main objection, and how the ad or landing page answers it	
What should they do next? One call to action	
Mandatories Logo use, legal lines, words to avoid	
How we will judge it The metric that decides the winner, and after how much spend or how many days	

STEP 2

Message: problem, promise, proof

Write three versions of each line, then pick the clearest. Use the words your buyers use on sales calls, not your internal product language.

Line	Version A	Version B	Version C
Problem What hurts			
Promise What changes			
Proof Why believe it			
Call to action			

A worked example

This uses TechDella's own published Paycape case study as the proof line.

Problem	"Your pipeline depends on outbound, and every month starts from zero."
Promise	"Get found by buyers who are already searching for what you sell."
Proof	"Paycape reached about 15,000 monthly organic visitors, with 50% of conversions from inbound, in a 5-month engagement." (Source: published case study. Re-confirm with the client before use in ads.)
Call to action	"Request a growth audit."

Proof rules

- ☐ Every number has a source and a timeframe, and the client has approved its use in ads.
- ☐ Quotes are verbatim and attributed, with permission.
- ☐ No implied guarantees ("double your leads") unless you can substantiate them; platforms and regulators treat these as misleading claims.
- ☐ Logos of clients appear only with written permission.

STEP 3

Hooks and formats to test

The first line of copy, or the first seconds of a video, decide whether anyone sees the rest. Test hooks against each other before you test anything else.

Hook type	Pattern	Works well on
Call out the reader	"Fintech marketers: ..." / "If you run a 10-person SaaS team ..."	LinkedIn, Meta
Name the pain	"Every month your pipeline starts from zero."	All
Specific result	A real number with a timeframe and named source	All (with permission)
Contrarian take	"Stop buying more leads. Fix the ones you have."	LinkedIn, TikTok
Show the work	Screen recording of a dashboard, a teardown, a before/after page	TikTok, Meta Reels, LinkedIn video
Founder or expert to camera	One person, one point, under 30 seconds	TikTok, Reels, LinkedIn Thought Leader Ads
Question	"Is ChatGPT recommending your competitors?"	All
Document / carousel	A short guide, checklist or framework people can swipe through	LinkedIn document ads, Meta carousel

Your hooks

#	Hook (first line or first 3 seconds)	Hook type	Format	Platform
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Video checklist

- ☐ The point lands in the first three seconds, with sound off.
- ☐ Burned-in captions or on-screen text, placed inside each platform's safe zone.
- ☐ Vertical 9:16 master; square and 4:5 cut-downs where the platform uses them.
- ☐ The logo or brand name appears early, without a long intro.

STEP 4

Test plan and naming

Change one thing per test, decide the winner on a metric close to revenue, and name every ad so the result is readable in six months.

01 **Hooks first.** Same body and visual, two to four different openings.

02 **Then the concept.** Take the winning hook and test a different visual approach (screen recording vs. person to camera vs. static).

03 **Then the offer.** Call vs. audit vs. guide. This often moves cost per qualified lead the most.

04 **Then the landing page.** Only once the ad is stable.

PICK THE DECIDING METRIC BEFORE LAUNCH

Click-through rate tells you about the hook. Cost per lead tells you about the offer. For B2B, judge winners on cost per **qualified** lead or per booked meeting, which means sending CRM outcomes back to the ad platform (offline conversions or a conversions API).

Naming convention

```
[platform]_[objective]_[audience]_[concept]_[hook]_[format]_[version]
Example:  li_leads_fintech-cmo_audit-offer_pain-hook_doc_v2
```

Test log

Test	Variable	Variants	Metric	Spend / days	Winner and why

STEP 5

Format specs: Meta and TikTok

Values from Meta's Ads Guide and TikTok's Ads Manager Help Center, checked October 2026. Platforms change limits and safe zones often, so recheck the pages in the sources before production.

META (FACEBOOK AND INSTAGRAM)

Placement / asset	Ratio	Recommended size	Notes
Feed image or video	1:1 or 4:5	4:5: 1440×1800 px	4:5 takes more screen space on mobile.
Stories and Reels	9:16	1440×2560 px	Keep text and logos out of the top 14%, the bottom 35% and 6% on each side, where the interface sits.
Carousel cards	1:1	At least 1080×1080 px	2 to 10 cards. Meta suggests about 80 characters of primary text and 20 for headlines.
Primary text	Put the message in the first line; longer text is truncated behind "See more". Meta recommends 50 to 150 characters for Facebook Feed and 44 for Instagram Reels.		
Headline	Short; it is truncated on many placements. Meta recommends 27 characters for Facebook Feed.		
Special ad categories	Ads about credit, employment, housing, or social issues, elections or politics must be declared, and targeting options are restricted.		

TIKTOK

Asset	Ratio	Recommended size	Notes
In-feed video	9:16	1080×1920 px	Vertical, full-screen, sound on by default for many users; still caption it. TikTok accepts 9:16 at 540×960 px or larger. Non-Spark videos can run up to 10 minutes; TikTok's spec page gives no recommended length, so test short cuts first.
Ad text	Short caption shown over the video. Up to 4 lines display, including emojis. Non-Spark captions do not support links, @ mentions or hashtags. Check the character limit in Ads Manager when you build the ad.		
Spark Ads	Promote an existing organic TikTok post (your account or a creator's, with their authorization code). Engagement stays on the original post.		
Safe zone	The right side (buttons) and bottom (caption, CTA) are covered by the interface. Keep text centered. The safe area shrinks as the caption gets longer. Download TikTok's safe-zone files from its In-Feed Ads spec page (standard, with anchor, and Arabic versions).		

STEP 5, CONTINUED

Format specs: LinkedIn and Google

Values from LinkedIn's and Google's help centers, checked October 2026. Recheck the pages in the sources before production.

LINKEDIN

Format	Ratio	Recommended size	Notes
Single image	1.91:1, 1:1, or 4:5 (mobile)	1200×628 / 1200×1200 / 720×900 px	Square and vertical usually take more feed space.
Video	16:9, 1:1, 4:5 or 9:16	Depends on ratio	Add captions (an SRT file or burned in).
Document ads	Any page size	PDF, PPT(X) or DOC(X)	Can be gated with a Lead Gen Form (PDF only for that objective). Up to 100 MB and 300 pages.
Thought Leader Ads	Promote a post from an employee's or other member's profile, with their approval.		
Intro text and headline	Intro text: up to 150 characters to avoid truncation (3,000 maximum); put the hook first. Headline: up to 70 characters to avoid truncation (200 maximum).		

GOOGLE ADS

Format	Assets
Responsive search ads	Up to 15 headlines (30 characters each) and up to 4 descriptions (90 characters each). Write headlines that make sense in any order; pin only when legally required.
Responsive display ads	Landscape image 1.91:1 (1200×628 px), square image 1:1 (600×600 px recommended), optional square logo 1:1 (1200×1200 px) and landscape logo 4:1 (1200×300 px); 1 to 5 short headlines (30 characters), 1 long headline (90 characters), 1 to 5 descriptions (90 characters), business name (25 characters).
Performance Max / Demand Gen	Performance Max minimum: 3 headlines (30 characters, one of 15 or fewer), 1 long headline (90), 2 descriptions (90), a business name (25), a landscape 1.91:1 image (1200×628 px), a square 1:1 image (1200×1200 px) and a square logo. Recommended: 11+ headlines, 4+ descriptions, vertical 4:5 images (960×1200 px), and your own 16:9, 1:1 and 9:16 videos of 10 seconds or more. If you add no video, Google may generate one.
YouTube	Horizontal 16:9 and vertical 9:16 (Shorts) versions. Front-load the brand and the point.
Financial services	Google requires financial services verification in specific countries, including the UK, Australia, India and most of the EEA. Where required, it covers all ad formats and assets. Check the country list on Google's verification page before you target a market.

BEFORE LAUNCH

Pre-launch checklist

- ☐ **Brief approved** by the owner named on page 2.
- ☐ **Every claim is sourced** and every client asset is used with permission.
- ☐ **Each ad matches its landing page**: same offer, same words, same visual.
- ☐ **Landing page loads fast on mobile** and the form works (test submit reaches the CRM).
- ☐ **Tracking is live**: platform pixel or tag and the conversions API or offline conversion import, firing only after consent where required.
- ☐ **UTM parameters** on every destination URL, following your naming convention.
- ☐ **Ad names follow the convention** on page 6.
- ☐ **Specs checked** for every placement; text inside safe zones; captions on.
- ☐ **Special categories declared** where required (Meta special ad categories, Google financial services verification).
- ☐ **Exclusions set**: current customers, employees, and open opportunities where appropriate.
- ☐ **Budget and end dates** set; a person checks spend on day 1 and day 3.
- ☐ **Example creative is labelled "Example"** wherever it is shown outside the ad account.

Want creative and media in one *team?*

We plan, make and run paid campaigns on Google, Meta, TikTok and LinkedIn, and judge them on qualified pipeline, not clicks.

Request a growth audit →

techdella.com/services/paid-ads/

REFERENCES

Sources

Specs and policies in this template come from the platforms' own help centers. Check each page before production; they change without notice.

1. Meta, "Meta Ads Guide" (format and placement specs). facebook.com/business/ads-guide (Facebook Feed, carousel, Instagram Stories and Reels pages)
2. Meta Business Help Center, "How to Choose a Special Ad Category". facebook.com/business/help/298000447747885
3. TikTok Ads Manager Help Center, "TikTok Auction In-Feed Ads" (specs and safe-zone files, updated June 2026). ads.tiktok.com/help/article/tiktok-auction-in-feed-ads
4. TikTok Ads Manager Help Center, "About Spark Ads". ads.tiktok.com/help/article/spark-ads
5. LinkedIn Help, "Single image ads advertising specifications" and "Document ads advertising specifications". linkedin.com/help/lms/answer/a426534, linkedin.com/help/lms/answer/a493903
6. LinkedIn Help, "Thought Leader Ads". linkedin.com/help/lms/
7. Google Ads Help, "About responsive search ads". support.google.com/google-ads/answer/7684791
8. Google Ads Help, "Responsive display ads specs and format requirements". support.google.com/google-ads/answer/17090561
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10. Google Advertising Policies Help, "Financial Services Verification" (country pages). support.google.com/adspolicy/answer/15332527
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